

SENATE No. 2731

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

SENATE, November 24, 2025.

The committee on Environment and Natural Resources to whom was referred the petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 660) of Bruce E. Tarr and Steven George Xiarhos for legislation to protect coastal resources by establishing the Massachusetts Coastal Erosion Innovation Center, report the accompanying bill (Senate, No. 2731).

For the committee,
Rebecca L. Rausch

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An Act to protect coastal resources..

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. There is hereby established the Massachusetts Coastal Erosion Innovation
2 Center, whose purpose shall be to develop, identify, research, advance and deploy innovative
3 means, methods, technologies and approaches for protecting and strengthening the resilience of
4 the state's coastal shoreline, including but not limited to beaches, marshes, dunes and public and
5 private property and infrastructure. The center shall be administered by the Executive Office of
6 Energy and Environmental Affairs, and shall consist of representatives of the Office of Coastal
7 Zone Management, the Department of Environmental Protection, the Department of
8 Conservation and Recreation, the Executive Office of Housing and Economic Development, and
9 the Executive Office of Administration and Finance, whom shall meet at intervals of not less
10 than 6 months for the purposes set forth in Section 3, provided that such meetings shall be open
11 to public observation, provided further that the center may elect to receive written or oral
12 testimony with proper notice given.

13 SECTION 2. The center shall be advised by an advisory group appointed by the
14 governor, comprised of 3 members representing municipal officials, selected from a list

submitted by the Massachusetts Municipal Association, 3 members representing environmental advocacy organizations in the commonwealth, 3 members representing owners of coastal property in the commonwealth, 3 members whom shall have expertise in engineering, construction, or architecture, 1 member with expertise in coastal geology, and 2 members representing the taxpayers of the commonwealth. Said advisory group shall meet not less than every 3 months, and at the request of the Innovation Center.

SECTION 3. The center shall identify, develop, and research, in consultation with one or more institutions of higher learning or research in the commonwealth, innovative methods of protecting coastal resources, with prioritization for natural approaches such as thin layer marsh deposition, living shorelines, vegetation, eradication of invasive plant and shellfish species such as green crab, and any other relevant methodology. The center shall produce an annual report of its activities, which shall be provided to the house and senate chairs of the joint committee on environment and natural resources, filed with the clerks of the house and senate and posted electronically for public inspection.

SECTION 4. The provisions of this act shall expire on December 31, 2035, unless otherwise repealed, modified or extended.